

Northwind Technologies - Travel and Expense Policy

1. General Principles

Employees should spend company money as carefully as they would spend their own. All expenses must be business related, reasonable, and supported by an itemised receipt.

2. Submission Deadlines

Expense claims must be submitted within 30 days of the expense being incurred. Claims submitted after 60 days will not be reimbursed except with written approval from the Finance Director. Reimbursements are paid with the next payroll cycle following approval.

3. Approval Thresholds

Expenses up to 5,000 INR are approved by the reporting manager. Expenses between 5,000 and 50,000 INR require department head approval. Anything above 50,000 INR requires Finance Director approval, obtained in advance rather than after the fact.

4. Air Travel

Economy class is standard for all flights under 6 hours. Premium economy is permitted for flights over 6 hours. Business class requires prior approval from the Finance Director. Flights should be booked at least 14 days in advance where the travel date is known.

5. Accommodation and Meals

Hotel spending is capped at 6,000 INR per night in metro cities and 4,000 INR per night elsewhere. The daily meal allowance is 1,500 INR per day of travel and does not require individual receipts. Alcohol is not reimbursable except at pre-approved client entertainment events.

6. Local Transport

Taxis and ride-hailing services are reimbursable for business travel. Personal vehicle use is reimbursed at 12 INR per kilometre. Parking and tolls are reimbursable with receipts. Traffic fines are never reimbursable.

7. Non-Reimbursable Items

The following are not reimbursed: personal entertainment, gym memberships, flight upgrades paid personally, laundry on trips shorter than four nights, and any expense already covered by a client.